Mr. Pepo Makes
Warm Vegetable Soup

A bedtime story by Peter Slizik



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A Story About Sharing

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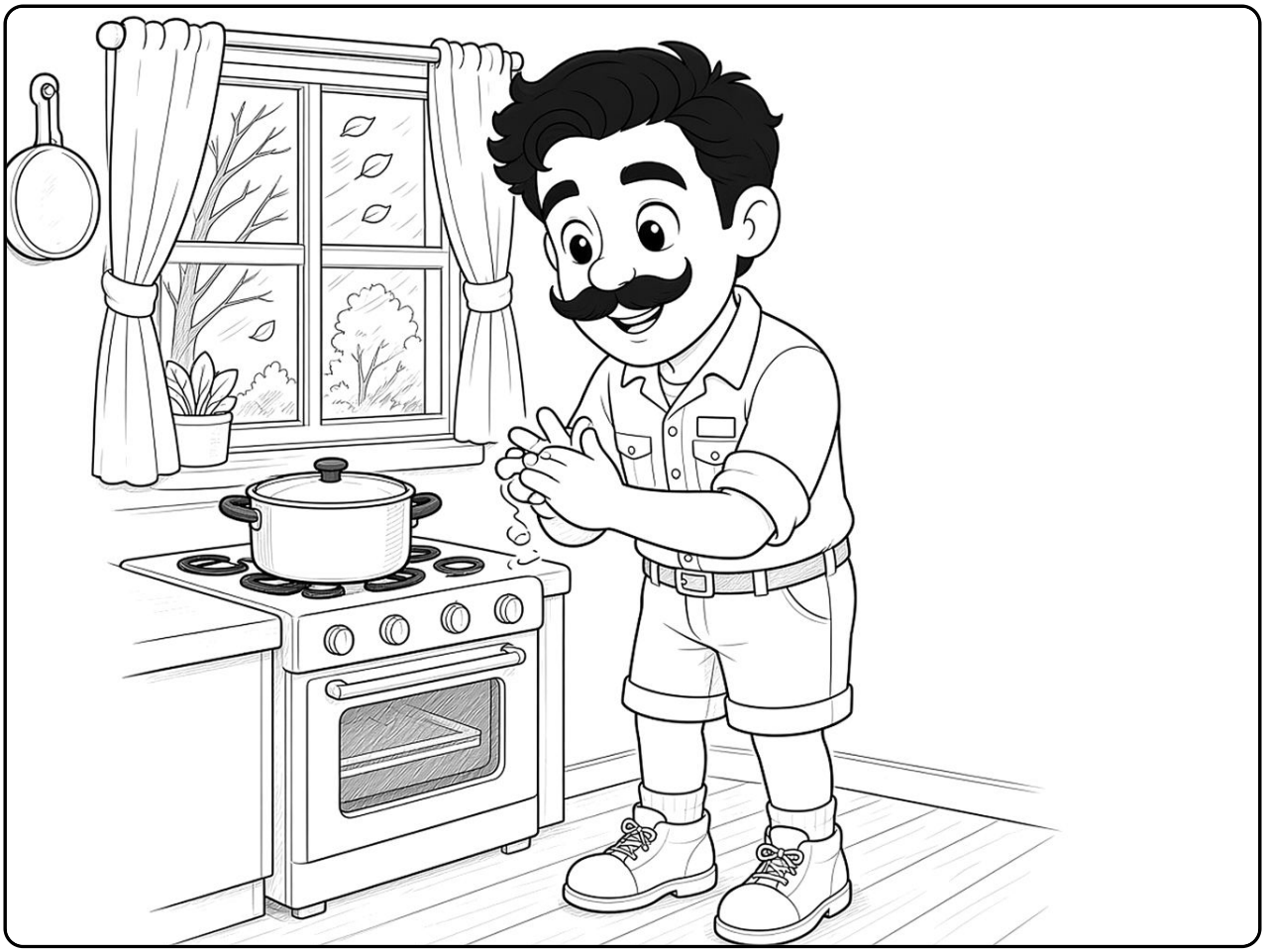
Happy birthday!

To: _____

Happy birthday from
Mr. Pepo, Luna and Sakura!

We hope your day is warm and cosy,
with a little bit of love in everything.

With love from: _____



It was a chilly evening, so Mr. Pepo decided to make warm vegetable soup.



He put on his apron. His moustache twitched as he read his list.

“Carrots. Potatoes. Peas. And a little bit of love,” he said. “That last one is the most important.”



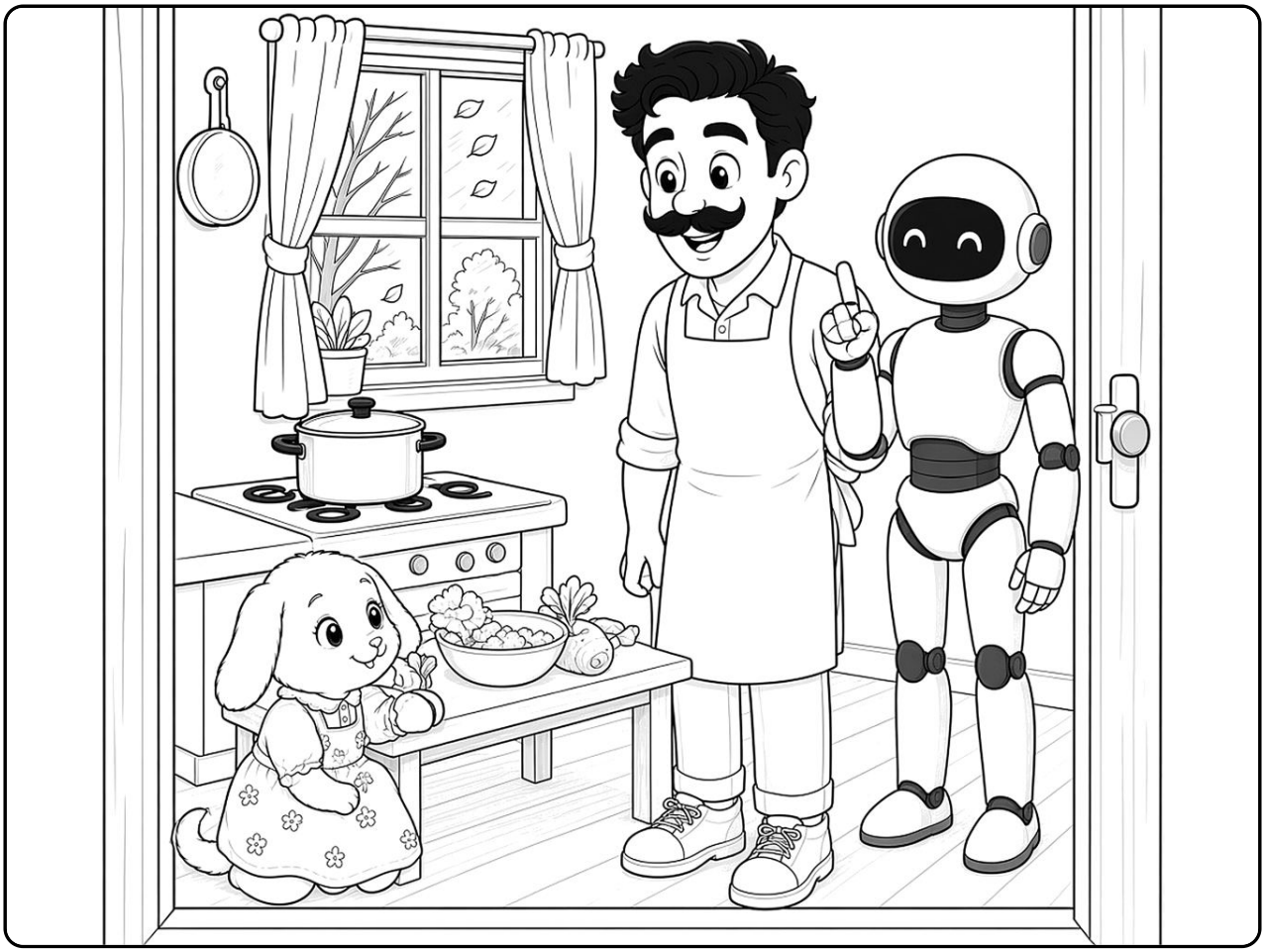
Sakura sat in the kitchen doorway. She was a black Labrador-type dog, with a slightly grey muzzle, kind brown eyes and a big smile.

She was in charge of watching, which is a very important job.



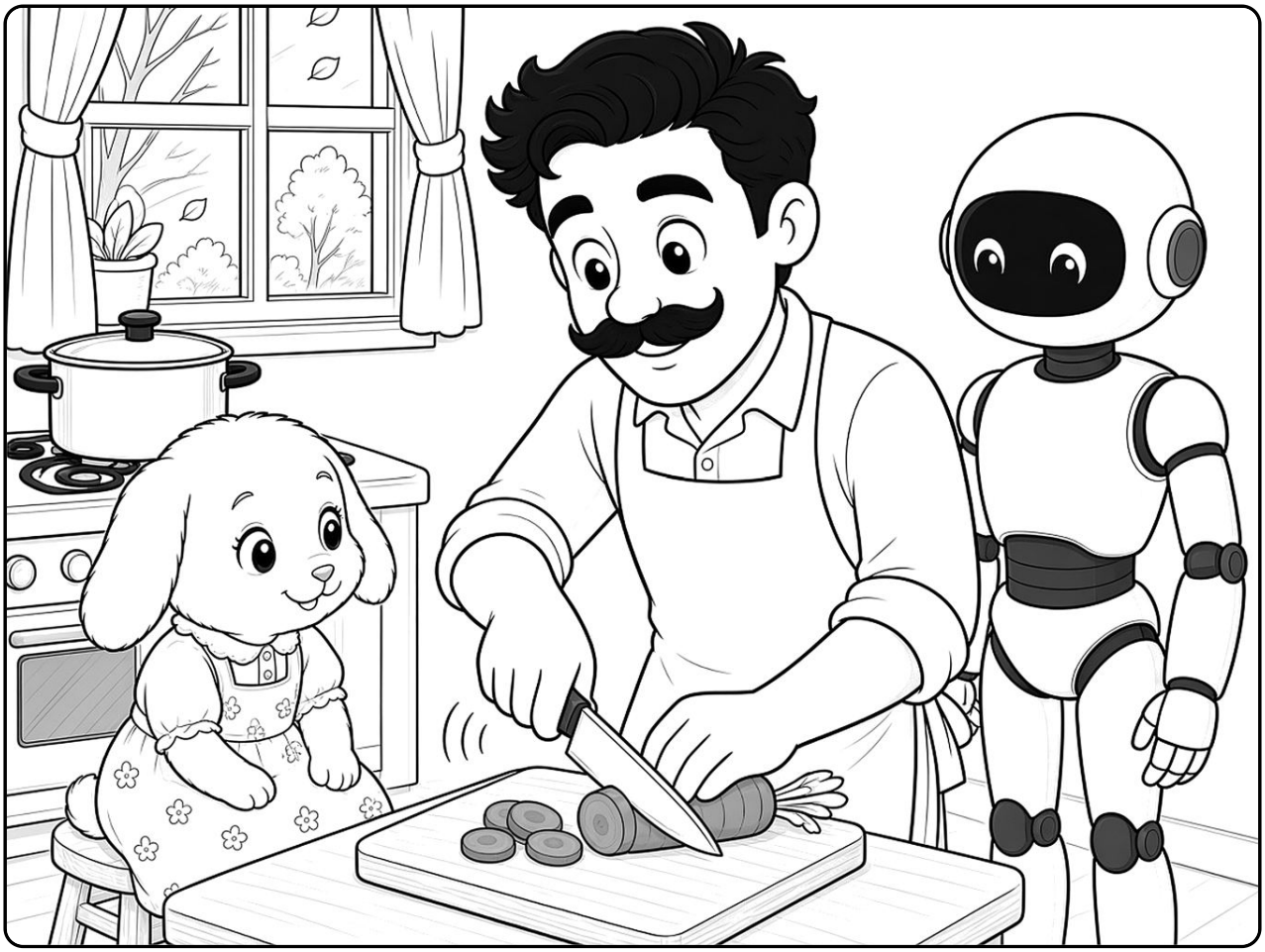
Howie hopped in, in her blue dress with white daisies, carrying two carrots very carefully.

“I washed them,” she said proudly. “Twice.”



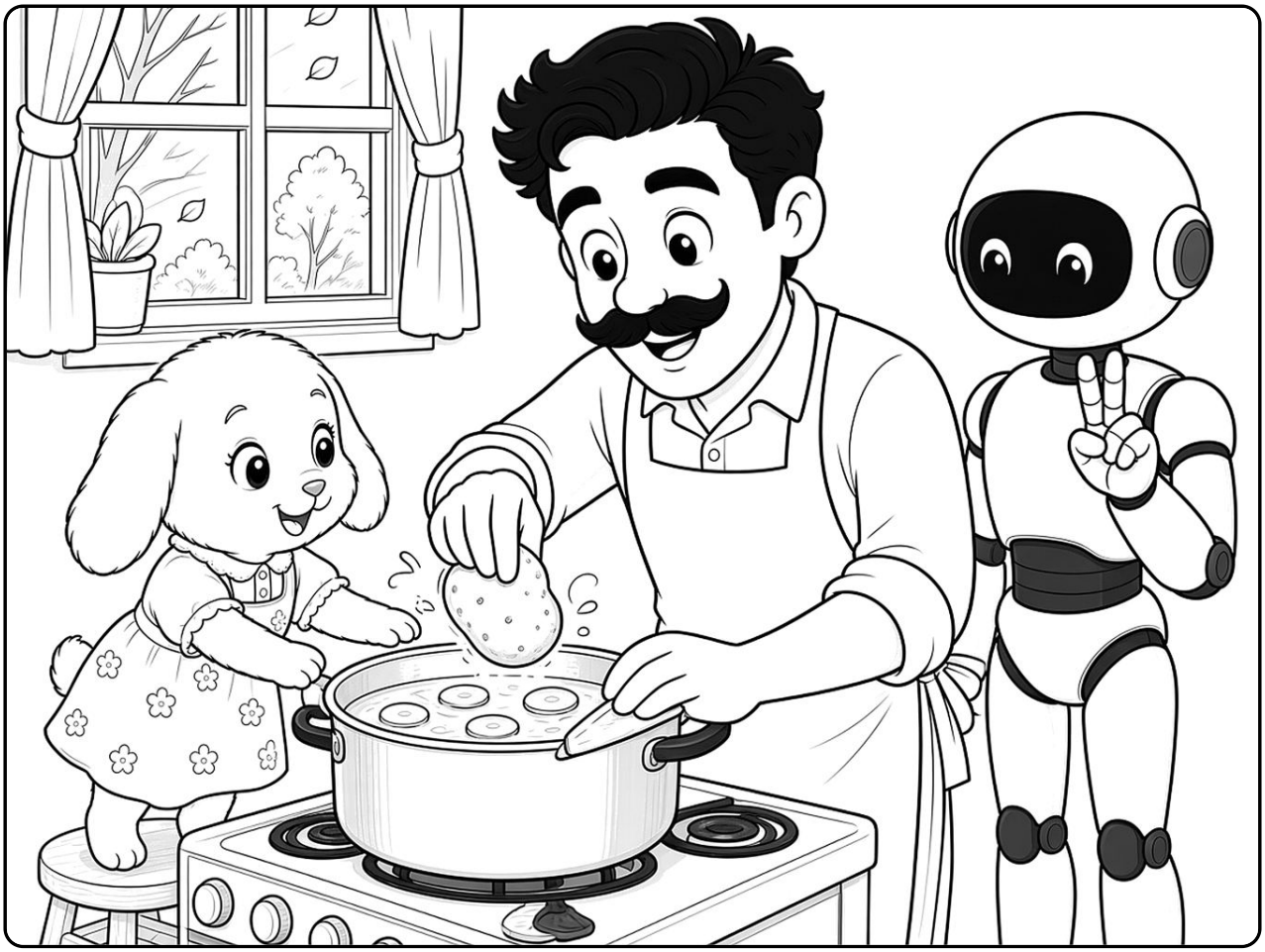
Luna the kind robot stood by the bench.

“I can count the vegetables as they go in,” she said. “Counting makes cooking feel calm.”



Mr. Pepo chopped slowly and safely.

Chop. Chop. Chop.

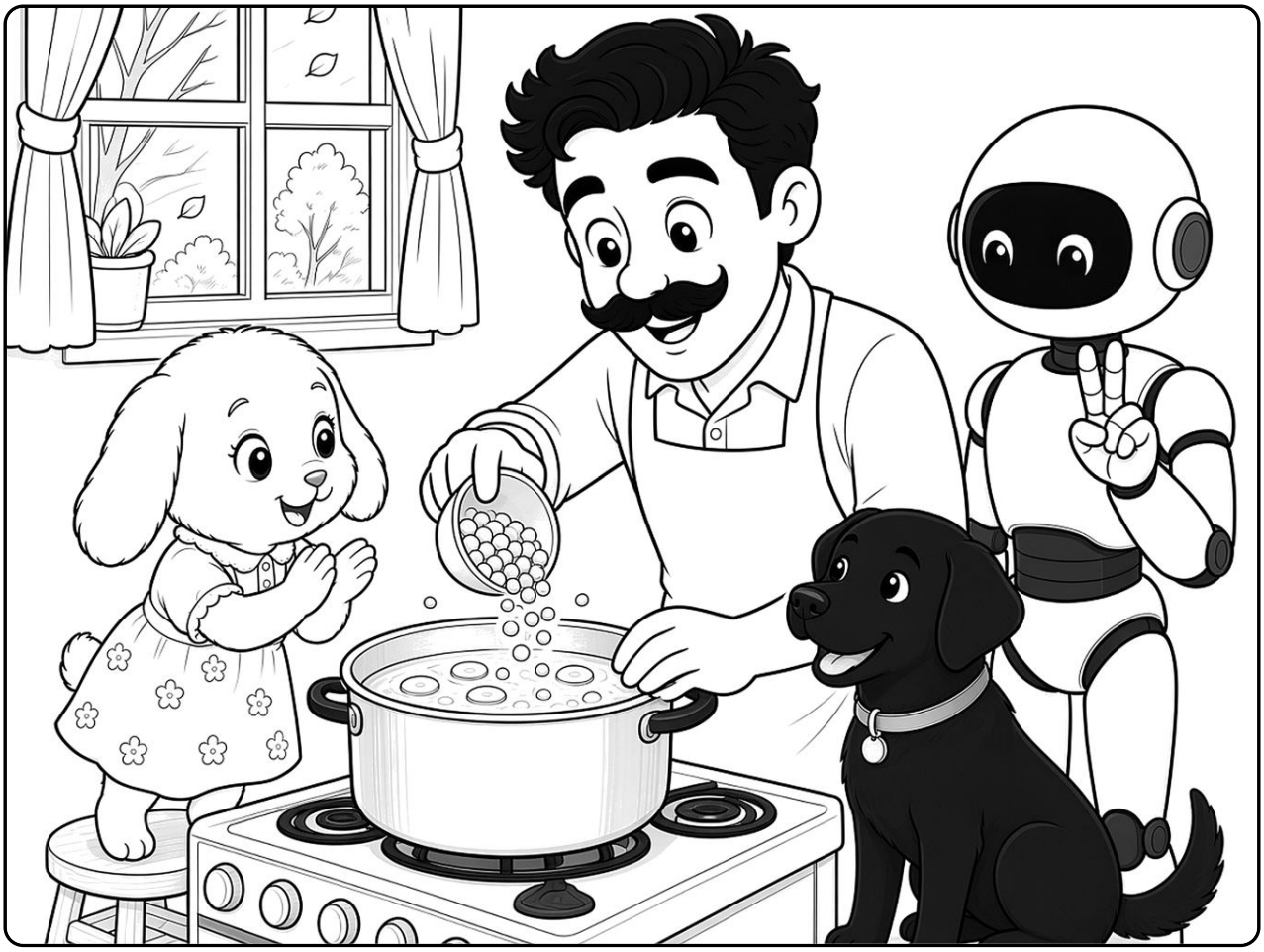


The carrots went into the pot. Plip.

“Carrots in,” counted Luna. “One vegetable.”

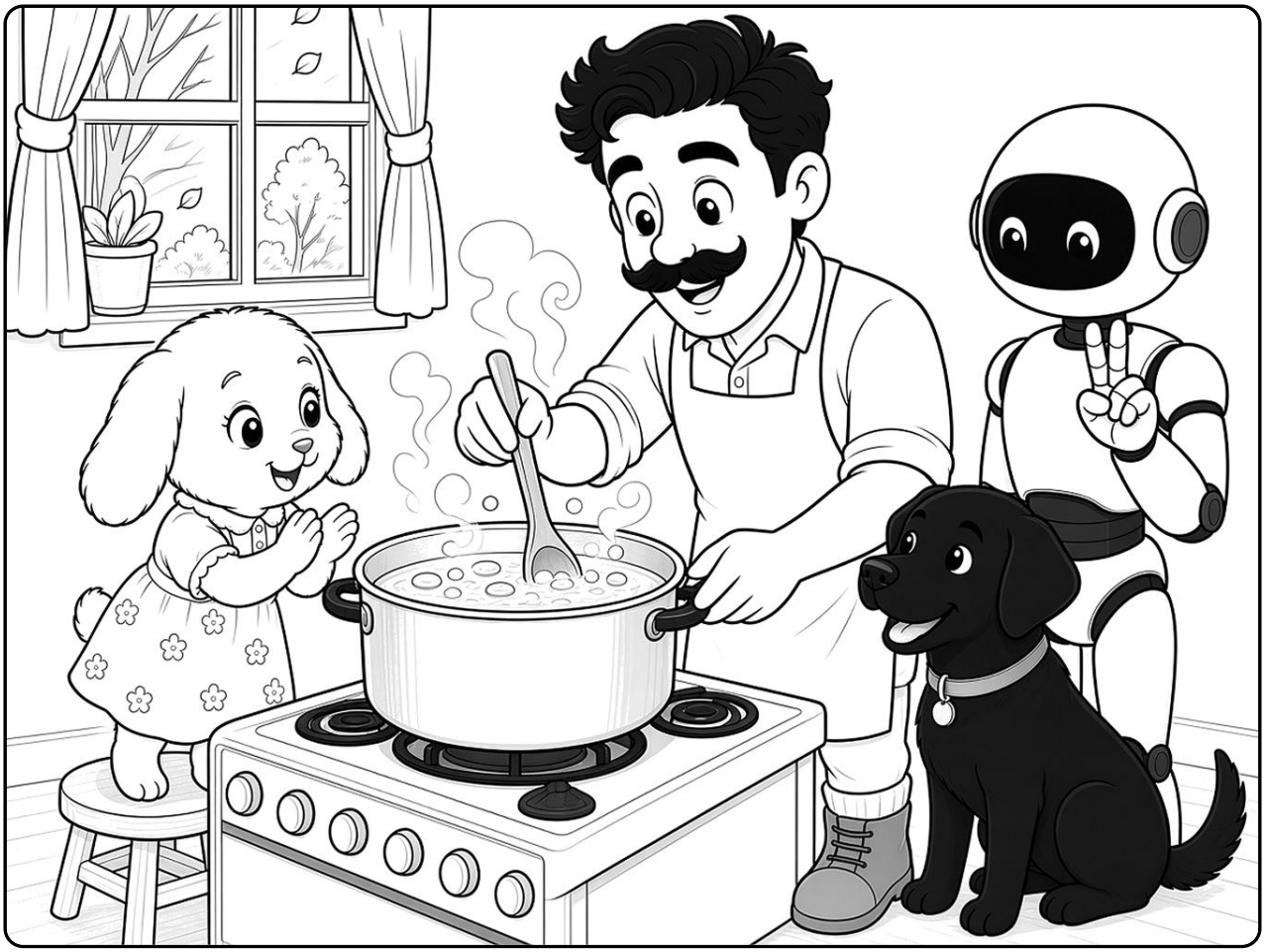
The potatoes went in next. Plop.

“Two vegetables,” said Luna.



The peas went in last, like tiny green beads. Plip, plip, plip.

“Three vegetables,” said Luna. “The soup is complete.”



Soon the pot was bubbling gently. It was a simple soup, made slowly at home — the kind of warm soup Mr. Pepo loved to cook for friends.

Bub-bub-bubble.



The kitchen smelled warm and good, and the windows went a little bit foggy in their small Sydney home.

Howie drew a smiley face in the fog on the window with her paw. “Even the window is happy,” she said.



Just then there was a very small knock at the door. Knock, knock.

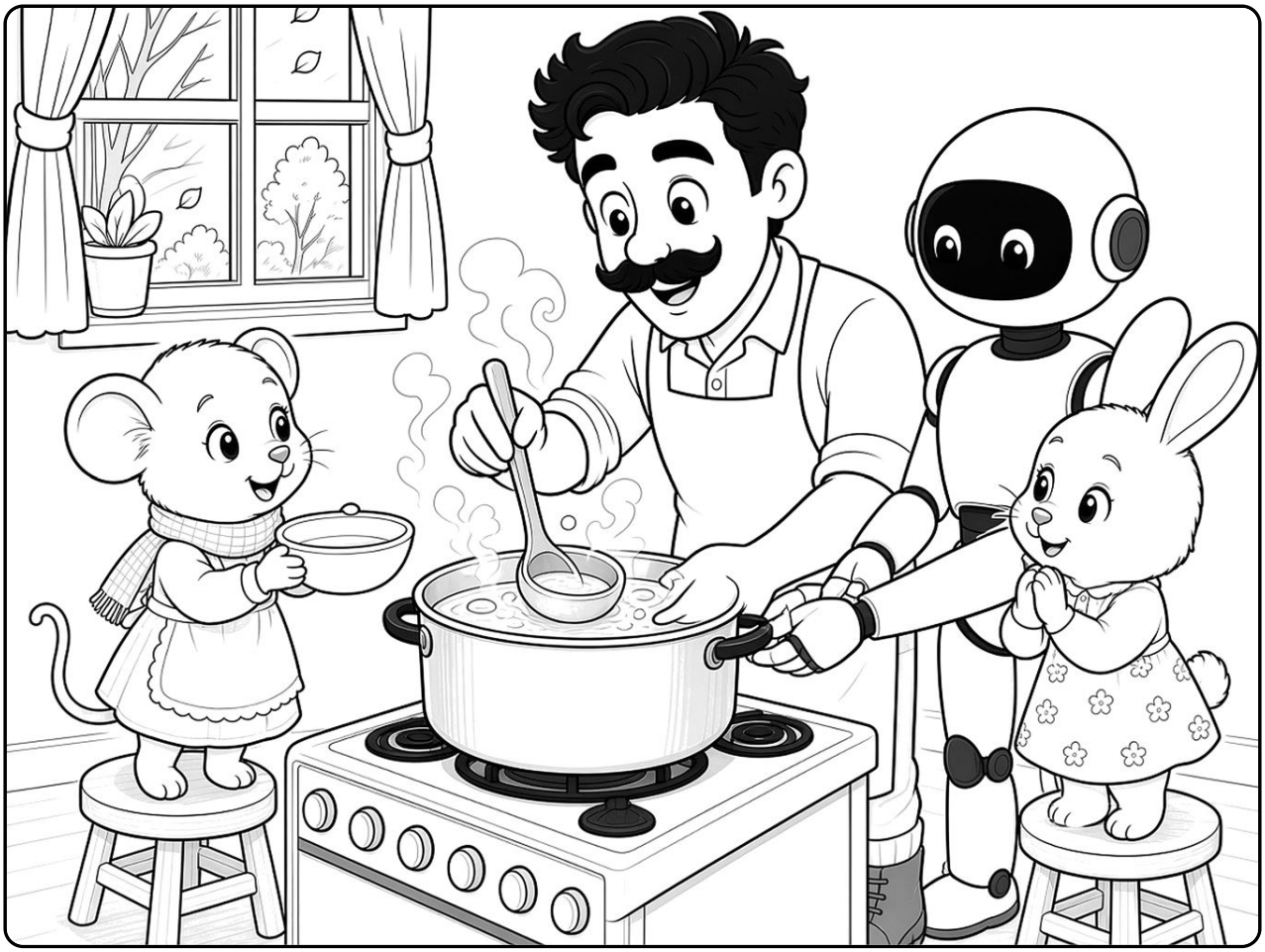
It was their neighbour, a tiny mouse, holding an empty bowl.

“Good evening,” said the mouse politely. “Something smells wonderful.”



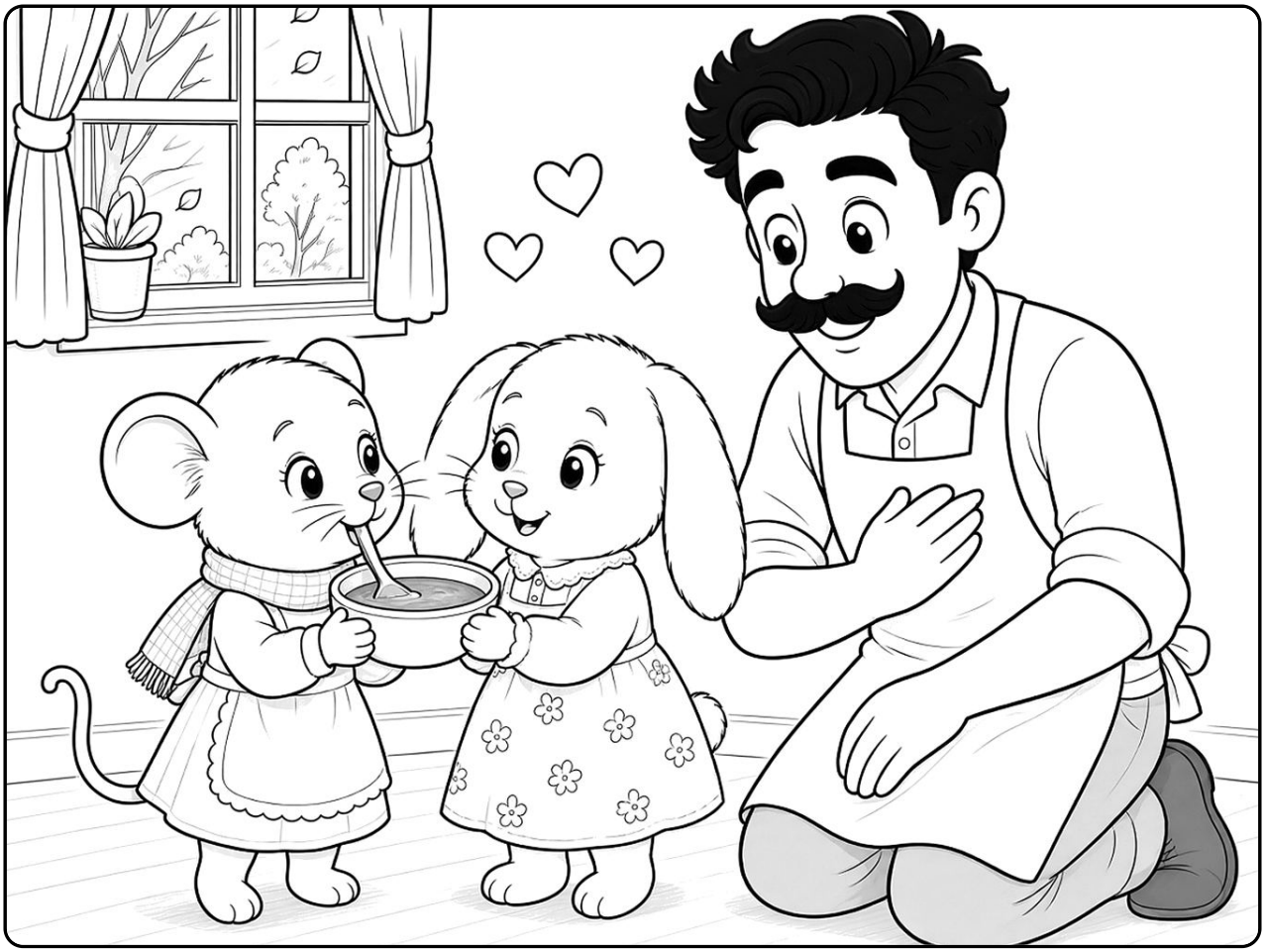
Her nose was pink and sniffly, and her whiskers drooped. “I feel poorly,” she said in a small voice, “and a little sad, all on my own.”

Mr. Pepo knelt down with a smile.



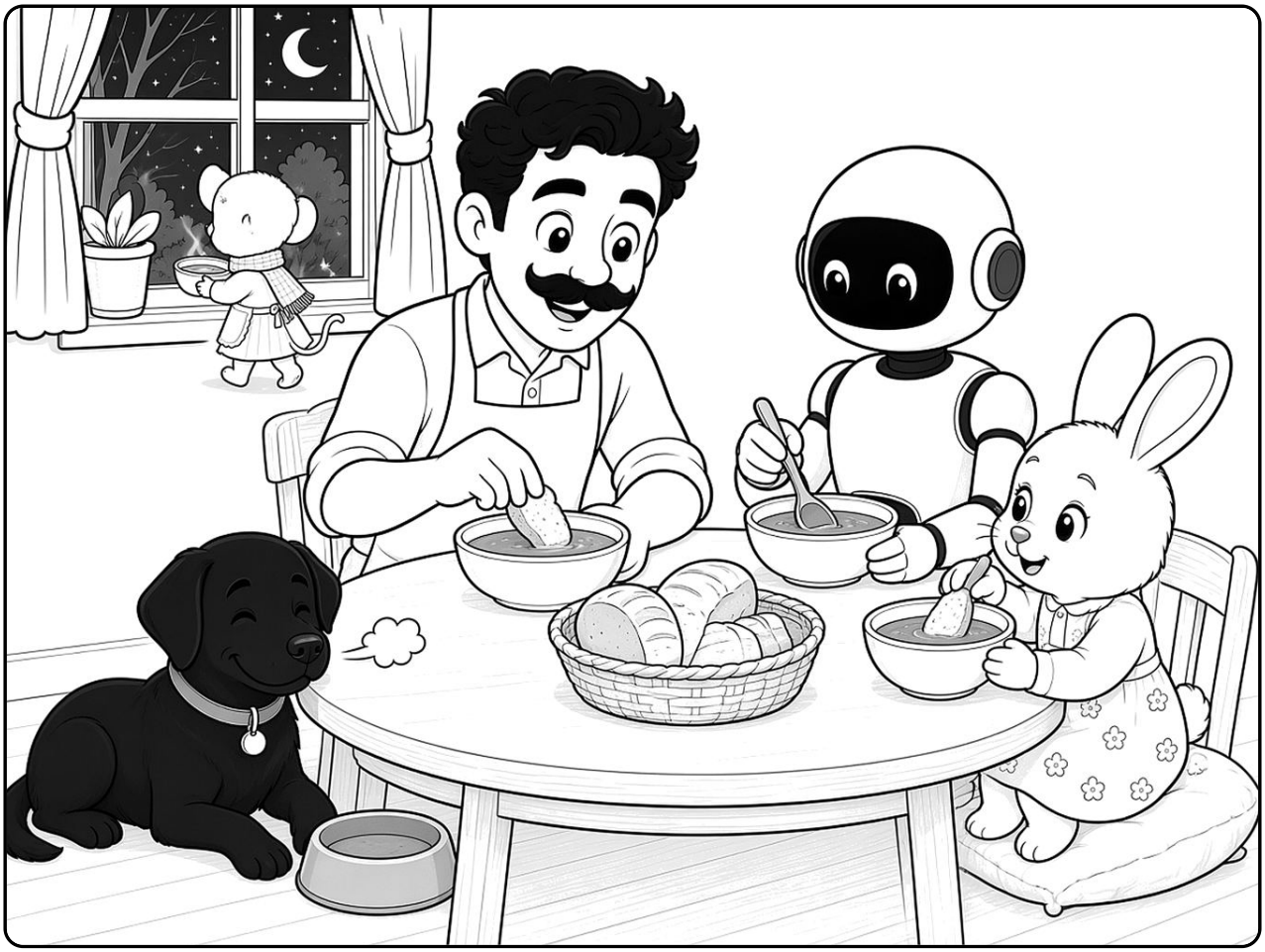
“We have plenty to share,” he said. “Would you like some warm soup for your supper?”

He filled the little bowl, not too full, so it would not spill.



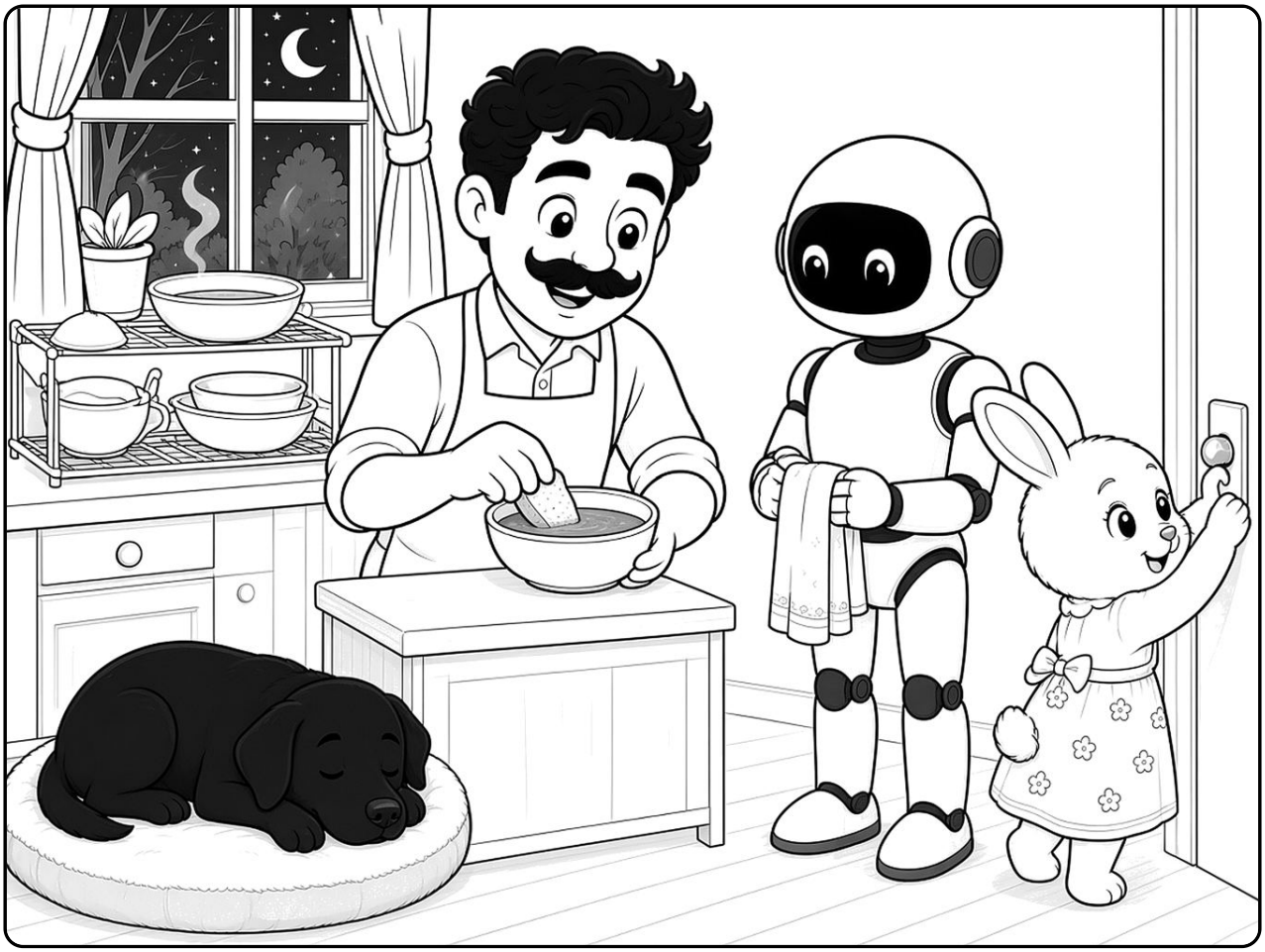
“And now the most important part,” he said softly, “a little bit of love.” He gave the mouse a gentle smile, and Howie gave her a gentle hug.

The mouse took one warm sip, and her whiskers lifted. “I feel better already,” she whispered.



The mouse carried it home with both paws, step by careful step.

Then the friends had their own soup, warm in their bowls, with soft bread for dipping. Sakura had her dinner too, and then lay down with a contented sigh.



Afterwards, Luna washed. Howie dried. Mr. Pepo put everything away, one thing at a time.

“Goodnight, kitchen,” whispered Howie, as the light went click.

And the house slept, warm and full and happy, with the good soup smell still floating gently in the air.



The End.

Sleep tight.

Mr. Pepo Makes Warm Vegetable Soup
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About the Author

Peter Slizik came to Sydney from Slovakia. He writes gentle bedtime stories about Mr. Pepo and his friends — Sakura the dog, Luna the kind robot and Howie the little bunny — full of small adventures, soft words and a cosy goodnight. He hopes these stories help little ones feel safe, brave and ready for sleep.

Colour me in!



Colour me in!



Colour me in!

